

THE ULTIMATE SALES MACHINE

Turbocharge Your Business
With Relentless Focus On 12 Key Strategies

CHET HOLMES



The Big “So What”



To succeed in business, you must master 3 vital areas: management, marketing and sales. This book breaks down exactly how to do that with **12 proven strategies which Holmes has used to build various businesses and to train business owners and employees.** These tips are useful for anyone involved in sales, marketing or operating a business/team.



Introduction



Ideas alone, no matter how good, are useless if they're not implemented. To master something, you must practice the same thing consistently until it becomes second-nature to you. **To build the Ultimate Sales Machine, you must apply the 12 strategies in this book with “pigheaded discipline”, honing and perfecting them until they become an integral part of how your organization operates.**

The book is organized into 12 chapters on time management, training, meetings, talent management, strategy, marketing, sales, ideal buyers, presentations, closing skills, follow-ups, and implementation. By mastering all of these areas, you can ensure the success of any business.

In this summary, we've organized the inter-related strategies and tips into 4 key parts: Management, Marketing, Sales, and Operating your Ultimate Sales Machine.



Part 1: Management



Every company has finite resources. To build an effective

KEY QUOTES

“The promise of this book is that you will learn how to create mastery in your business resulting in the finest, most profitable, and best-run business you can have.”

“Mastery is not about being special or more gifted...Mastery is a direct result of pigheaded discipline and determination.”

“It is the same with any business; there are basics that you can do over and over again until every aspect runs like a machine.”

organization, you must gain control of your time, maximize your productivity, and help your team to do the same.



Improve Productivity with Key Impact Areas

Rather than react to issues as they surface, gain control of your time by managing key “impact areas”.



Identify your key impact areas, i.e. areas that directly affect the bottomline, e.g. customer service, inventory control, external sales, internal telemarketing, technology, partner relations. The number of impact areas will depend on the size and nature of your business.



Set aside 1-hour weekly for focused meetings to **improve each impact area**, with the goal of making incremental improvements that add up to massive progress.



Instead of spending 70-80 hours a week tackling ad-hoc issues, you can now spend several hours focused on upgrading the key aspects of your business, thus **multiplying your impact with less time**. To do this, you must say “no” to ad-hoc requests and insist on focusing your time only on vital issues in your weekly meetings.



Improve Productivity with Great Time Management

These 6 steps can be done in just 5 minutes—apply them in your whole organization to significantly increase your productivity.



Touch it once. Only touch something if you’re prepared to act on it, so you don’t waste time revisiting issues or rereading material. Insist that your staff use specific and descriptive titles for their emails and update the titles as the content changes—that way, you can choose to only open emails that you can deal with immediately.



Make daily lists of your **6 most important tasks**, and make sure you finish them. This is better than having a long list of items and feeling bad about not completing them.



Allocate time to each task in advance, to ensure you can complete all 6 tasks. Ideally, you should spend about 6 hours

KEY QUOTES

“Good time management shouldn’t take a lot of time.”

“Email is there for your convenience. If it’s not convenient, don’t answer it.”

for the 6 tasks; if a task requires too much time, break it down into smaller parts.



Plan your day: assign specific time slots for each task and stick to it.



Prioritize the most important and difficult projects first in your schedule, so you have enough time and energy for them.

- If you're a salesperson or 1-man team, make sure you spend at least 2.5 hours a day growing your business.
- Even if you're in a "reactive" role like a receptionist or personal assistant, you can still dedicate time daily to improve the company rather than wait passively for instructions.



About 80% of our files and stored information is never used again. Ask yourself "will it hurt me to throw this away?" and remove what you don't need.



Reprogram your Organization with Effective Training

Your training system is robust only if (a) all your staff define "great performance" the same way and can perform their jobs consistently well, and (b) all your clients receive a similar experience.



Unfortunately, 90% of people won't actively seek to improve themselves unless it's a job requirement. To ensure your team performs well and constantly improves, make continuing education mandatory.



Use these tips to make your training effective:

- Design regular programs to (a) train new employees, (b) upgrade the skills/effectiveness of existing employees, (c) provide professional development, and (d) solve problems.
- Prepare people in advance, by letting them know what to expect (training duration, objective, takeaways etc).
- Use a blend of methods (e.g. lectures, discussions, role-plays, quizzes, demos, case studies). Keep it fun and stimulating so people will look forward to it and retain the learning.

KEY QUOTES

"Master these six steps and you won't believe the difference. Implement them companywide and you will be operating at maximum productivity before you know it."

- It's better to teach a few items and reinforce it with practice/application, than to teach a lot of new things each time. Use regular training to reinforce the same skills and information repeatedly until it is permanent.



Use “Workshop Meetings” to Improve your Company

To grow a large company, you must be able to hire 50 new people in a week and help them perform at their peak quickly. **Structured workshop-style meetings are one of the best ways to concurrently train people and improve your business.**



During workshops, you work with your staff to jointly develop ideas to improve your business, rather than give instructions on what to do. This provides a platform for people to solve problems, improve outcomes and deliver a shared vision.



To run effective workshops:

- Run workshops weekly. Each workshop should have up to 30 people and focus on 1 small part of the business. For large companies, hold separate weekly workshops for each department.
- Define a key challenge to solve at each workshop. You can get participants to brainstorm key challenges, giving them 3 minutes to list down 3 areas to be improved in the company/department, then get everyone to share their ideas on a whiteboard. A good topic is: “What else can we offer the buyer at the point of sale?”
- Next, prioritize the list of issues. Give the participants 30 seconds to write to down their top 3 choices in order of priority, then add up the scores to identify the top 5 issues.
- Tackle each issue in a separate workshop. After each session, summarize the solutions in 1-2 page memos (e.g. “9 ways to handle an angry customer”, “7 ways to improve product consistency”). Compile them and use them as training manuals.
- Test and refine the procedures over time, removing ineffective solutions and finalizing the proven ones as your standing policies.

KEY QUOTES

“No one gets good at anything without repetition.”



Use these 10 steps to implement a new policy effectively:

- To get buy-in and motivate learning, you must get people to feel the pain. Get people to discuss and vote for their top 3 problems. Then, ask questions like, “what if you could put in extra work now but remove most of these issues?” Amplify the pain with questions like “what are the drawbacks of not addressing this issue?” and get them to write down their answers.
- Generate solutions through a workshop, using the tips earlier.
- From the list of solutions generated, define a conceptual solution to be tested.
- Get your top leaders or talents to test and improve the solutions before training others.
- Set a deadline to complete the testing, with updates at your weekly meetings.
- Document the step-by-step processes, including scripts, activities, procedures, expected outcomes etc.
- Get your top performers to teach others using show-and-tell and role-play.
- Hold another workshop with your staff to refine and perfect the solution before rolling it out.
- Monitor the procedures weekly (or even daily) so you can observe and make corrections immediately.
- Set specific criteria, measure results and reward your team for the desired new behaviors or outcomes, until they become second nature to every employee.



Hiring and Managing Superstars

As an employer, you must be able to attract and manage top producers. As an employee, you must know how to be a top producer.

KEY QUOTES

“I had learned the secret to creating change: you have to put people in pain.”

“I always recommend testing new ideas with your top performers.”

“People respect what you inspect.”



Top producers take the initiative to do more, excel and keep learning. They can turn around a bad situation, outperform all your staff and deliver results beyond expectations. The tips below relate to sales positions, but you can adapt them for other positions.



To hire superstars, be prepared to share the wealth if they successfully build your company.

- Estimate how much you can afford to pay if they perform. For SMEs or 1-person armies, estimate the monetary rewards/value of your top 3 initiatives if they're executed well. For medium to large companies, list up to 3 core positions which are not currently filled by superstars, and estimate the value that a superstar could generate. If you can share 30% of a \$100,000 sales target, that means an attractive \$30,000 monthly income for that superstar.
- Hire for personal qualities, not background. Identify the personality profile of someone who'd succeed in the job, then find tools to assess the desired profiles. For example, a good salesperson is likely to have high scores in "Dominance" and "Influence" using DISC personality profiling—such people can relate to and influence customers, dare to make decisions and deal with rejections.
- Design your ads, using the highest possible income figure and word it to attract confident people, e.g. "Superstars only. \$180-\$300k. Don't call unless you're an overachiever and can prove it."
- Pre-screen the applicants: Explain your objectives over the phone, and say something like "Our ad says we're only hiring superstars. Tell me why we should hire you." After they've done their pitch, reject them just to see their response (e.g. "That's great, but I don't hear a top producer"). A true superstar will challenge and persuade you, instead of accepting the rejection.



After shortlisting your potential candidates, use this 3-step process to interview your superstars:

- o Relax. Start by being friendly so they'll relax and be at their best.

KEY QUOTES

"(You can) grow any company or area faster if you're wise enough to share the wealth."

"If you want to have the Ultimate Sales Machine, you need to have the ultimate salespeople."

- o Probe. Explain that your company hires based on personality profile, and that you'll be asking a series of personal questions to understand them. Probe to see if they offer details and stories to win you over. Some areas to cover include:
 - (a) Childhood, e.g. "What aspects of your childhood have shaped who you are today?" or "What was the biggest challenge you've faced in your life?";
 - (b) Areas of accomplishment e.g. "Tell me 2-3 things you're most proud about yourself" or "Can you share an area in life where you've reached a high level of achievement?";
 - (c) Commitment to self-improvement, e.g. "How do you improve yourself?" or "What's the last self-help book you've read?";
 - (d) Benchmark against the best: e.g. "Who is the best salesperson you've ever met?"—see if they name themselves, or can differentiate themselves from the person they've named;
 - (e) Their resume, e.g. "Why did you leave your last job?", "Tell me about a disagreement you've had with a boss and what happened." Look for those who can identify gaps in their previous jobs without complaining.
- Attack. By now, you have a good idea of how they think. Launch a strong but tactful attack to assess their response. Say something like, "This has been great, but I don't really get the impression you're a superstar." A real superstar will remain confident and present his/her case.



Managing superstars. To retain top producers:

- Never say "no". Instead, redirect their energy or throw them a challenge, e.g. get 30% more sales to grant their request, or challenge them to solve a problem they've raised.
- Compliment them when they meet and exceed your challenge.

KEY QUOTES

"Superstars never crumble. They have tremendous faith in themselves."



Part 2: Marketing



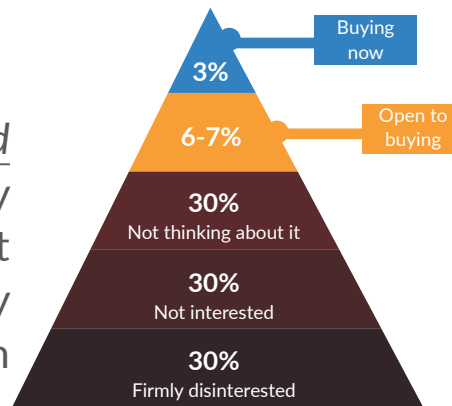
Multiply your Impact with Sound Strategies

To be a great strategist, you must be able to see the big picture and implement the strategies at the tactical level.



One of the biggest challenges in business is to catch and retain the attention of your prospects. Use the “**buyers pyramid**” to look at your market strategically. Based on 20 years of research, Holmes found that at any one time, for any product or “service”

- 3% of the market are buying now;
- 7% are open to the idea of buying;
- 90% are currently not interested in your product: 1/3 are simply not considering it, 1/3 are not interested, and 1/3 are strongly disinterested and want to stay with the status quo.



Most businesses focus only on the first 2 categories. It's more strategic to concurrently nurture the other 90%.



Focus on market data instead of product data. A headline like “5 ways to benefit from our video-conferencing services” will only appeal to the 3%+7%, while “5 reasons why 96% of businesses fail” could appeal to a much bigger prospect base.



Education-based marketing is one of the most effective ways to reach the entire buyers pyramid.

- Most people are not experts in the products they're buying, and you can “reset” customers' buying criteria by teaching them how to be better customers of your product/services.
- For the 90% who're not currently considering your products, your goal is to capture their interest, build rapport, add value and position yourself as an expert, so you become the obvious choice when they're ready to buy in the future. For

KEY QUOTES

“The hardest thing we need to do today is grab the attention of potential buyers and keep their attention long enough to help them buy your product.”

“One of the most strategic things you can do is to find market data that makes your product or service more important.”

“When you sell, you break rapport. When you educate, you build it.”

“You will attract way more buyers if you are offering to teach them something of value to them than you will ever attract by simply trying to sell them your product or service.”

example, you may offer a free course on “5 Reasons Why Businesses Fail”, with useful insights on business challenges like customer service, management or communication. This allows you to incorporate case studies of how certain companies used your video-conferencing solutions to deepen relationships with customers and staff.



Find your marketing angle using the “stadium pitch” exercise:

- If you could fill a stadium with your *ideal prospects*, who will be in that stadium (i.e. what’s the profile of your buyers pyramid)?
- In order to get everyone in the stadium to stay and listen to you, what must the title of your talk be?
- Invest time and resources to develop your stadium pitch, supporting it with data that set the buying criteria in your favor. This will become the your “core story” and the anchor of your marketing strategy.



There will always be some fact that will position you as the indisputable choice for your prospects—this is your “smoking gun”, and it’s your job to find it. For example, the smoking gun for selling art to hospitals could be the evidence that certain types of art can drastically improve patients’ rate of recovery.



It takes time and persistent effort to find your smoking gun and develop a great core story. Use workshop meetings to develop ideas with your team and dedicate some time weekly to do market research until you find your smoking gun.



Master the 7 Marketing Essentials

These are the key marketing tools you’d need to build your Ultimate Sales Machine. **Identify the ones that will give you the best returns on investment, run workshops with your team to master these tools and keep finding ways to incorporate your core story.**



Advertising. To have a big impact, your ads must meet these criteria:

- Be distinctive, i.e. they stand out and stop people in their tracks.

KEY QUOTES

“No matter who you are or what you sell, you need to take the time to collect market data and build your core story or your stadium pitch.”

“Tell a story that intrigues the imagination and you stand a better chance of people actually watching your commercial.”

“Like the headline, the body copy should be benefit-oriented. Don’t tell me what it is. Tell me why it is valuable.”

- Have an attention-grabbing headline with a self-explanatory benefit focused on “you” (the buyer).
- Have a body copy that holds the prospects’ interest and focuses on the key benefits for them.
- Include a call-to-action, e.g. a number to call or a coupon for the first X callers.



Direct mail. Use your stadium pitch as the foundation for your direct mails. Entice people to open your mail with benefits-oriented messages on the envelope, bright colours and even creative gifts (see Part 3 for more ideas). You’ll need to send your direct mail frequently and follow up with a phone call.



Brochures. Your corporate brochures should summarize the key points from your core story. Remember to focus on the buyers and how they can benefit, not on how great your company is.



Personal contact with your clients (be it a phone call or a meeting) by your salespeople and customer service staff can be one of the most powerful marketing opportunities.



Market education can be delivered in many ways, e.g. trade shows, speaking engagements and education-based marketing.



Public Relations (PR) can include trade shows, press parties, speaking-engagements, press releases or articles about you.

- A good PR piece should cover a broad issue that affects many people, with mention of your company without focusing on it. You should include credible/mainstream sources of information, and cite a Fortune 500 company if you have good reason to do so. Include data from your core story that would interest your target readers, and follow up on each press release with a phone call. Even if you’re brushed off initially, you can build a relationship over time with the editor, and position yourself as a domain expert.
- Charity events and award ceremonies can also generate great publicity, especially if you can invite market influencers, notable people and/or your dream clients.

KEY QUOTES

“None of your marketing efforts will have as much impact on your client as personal contact with your salespeople or customer service reps.”



Use the internet—including email, websites, and affiliate marketing—to capture leads, build relationships, interact with prospects, offer webinars, and convert leads to sales. You can build databases by having many microsites that focus on just 1 thing—e.g. www.howtodoublesales.com—then connect subscribers with the rest of your content. You can also build a community around your websites, e.g. if you sell filtered water, your sites can educate people about water, discuss how to protect our natural water sources etc.



Part 3: Sales



Getting your Ideal Buyers

For any product/service, there's always a small group of ideal clients who will buy more, and buy more frequently, than all other clients. Capturing this segment is the fastest and most cost-effective way to grow your business. Holmes call this the "Dream 100 strategy".



The best way to secure your ideal buyers is through sheer determination.

- When you consistently add value, they'll eventually notice you, and even feel obligated to do business with you. Once you've sold to an ideal buyer (e.g. a Fortune 500 company), it becomes easier to convince others to do business with you.
- For example, a real estate broker was able to serve the bulk of an upscale neighborhood after she consistently marketed to the neighbourhood for years. With the same perseverance, Holmes made himself visible to the top names in Hollywood until his screenplay was noticed and eventually bought by Warner Bros.



The same principle applies to getting your dream affiliates, i.e. people who don't sell your product/services, but have access to your customers and can help to promote your solutions. For 2 years, Holmes called and wrote to Jay Abraham every other week to pitch for a collaboration, before Jay decided to meet him. This meeting led to sales worth over \$15mil, with profits shared by both sides.

KEY QUOTES

"Every product or service can create a community—even bottled water or shaving cream."

"The fastest way to grow any company is to focus a special and dedicated effort on your dream clients."

"The more they become familiar with your name, the better your chance of gaining them as clients."

"To build the Ultimate Sales Machine, you must devote machinelike precision to chase and tackle those dream prospects."



6 Steps to implement your “Dream 100 strategy”



Identify your dream clients. List down your ideal buyers, then refine your criteria. Collect as much information as possible about the companies that meet these criteria—through their websites, phone calls or research sites like Hoovers.



Select great gifts. One of the best ways to get noticed is to send small gifts every 2 weeks. Choose useful but inexpensive gifts that are relevant to your pitch—these won’t seem like bribes, and will likely be used by the prospects.



Create your letters to go with the gifts. Keep it short and link the message creatively to your gift, e.g. flashlight (“don’t be kept in the dark...”), Rubik’s Cube (“don’t be puzzled by...”), calculator (“calculate your savings...”). Always include a call-to-action that focuses on your offer (e.g. free course or consultation).



Map out your calendar and what you’ll send for the next 3-6 months. You should send something minimally once a month, and ideally every 2 weeks. You can combine these with marketing tools like cards, surveys, coupons, PR articles etc.



Follow up with phone calls. Your goal is to secure an appointment to get the core story in front of them.

- For B-to-B sales, it can be hard to reach the decision maker. Use an authoritative tone, sound important and stay in charge of the conversation. For example, don’t start your call with “how are you today?”. Instead, say “Hi, this is Bill Allen. Is Tom in?”.
- During the appointment, use the earlier tips to present your core story: educate them using market data, target their pain points, set the buying criteria in your favour, and use the “smoking gun”.



Mastering your Presentations



Use these tips for effective presentations.

- Use compelling visual aids. 85% of information to our

KEY QUOTES

“Build that list, organize your approach, and never say die.”

“Massive and diligent follow-up can penetrate just about any company if you are determined.”

brain comes through our eyes. The right visual aids (e.g. using specific colours, pictures of human figures) can help to capture attention, communicate more and improve retention.

- K.I.S.S. (Keep it Simple, Stupid): Limit each slide to 1 big heading and 3-4 bullet points.
- K.I.F.P. (Keep it Fast Paced): Cover 2-3 slides per minute, with a new point appearing visually every 15s. For webinars, flash new images across the screen constantly.
- Use WOW Facts or stats that your audience will remember and share with others.
- Use stories to illustrate a point and make it stick.
- Maintain curiosity: offer facts followed by explanations, and keep telling them what else is coming up.
- Use every headline to sell the slide and keep things interesting.
- Be confident but not arrogant. Convey authority using your words, tone of voice and body language. Try to build a rapport with everyone in your audience, e.g. getting them to talk about their problems.
- Always focus on them, not on you.

Avoid these common presentation mistakes:

- Don't thank them or apologize for taking up their time.
- Don't present sitting down or with your hands in your pockets. Stand up and keep your hands outside, above your waist.
- Don't lose control, e.g. let questions to disrupt your presentation.
- Don't read off your slides.
- Don't be too serious. A little humor always helps.
- Don't underprepare. Always rehearse out-loud before every

KEY QUOTES

"Don't be lazy. Work to make every headline work hard for you."

"Misery loves company, so engaging (your prospects) on problems creates an instant bond."

"Never apologize or thank them for their time. If you do a good job, then they will thank you."

"Often, a great education can make people realize they need your product."

presentation. Know your whole presentation so you can insert criteria and ideas to presell what's coming up.



Perfecting your Sales Engine



Master the 7 Steps in Selling. Get your entire team to memorize and practice these steps until they are ingrained in their “subconscious competence”. Use workshops to teach, practice and perfect your sales process.

- Establish rapport. The better your rapport with a client, the more secure the account. You should minimally know their background, family, interests and personal goals, and ideally become friends with them. Role play with your team on how to ask great questions, find common ground and build trust.
- Discover their buying criteria, and concurrently work to reset it so your solutions become the obvious choice. Work with your team to develop questions that they can use to know the prospects better.
- Build value around your product/service, e.g. teach your customers about manufacturing and how to identify a good vs bad product.
- Create desire. Develop a series of questions and killer data to help your prospects see why the status quo is unacceptable.
- Overcome objections. Learn your buyers' criteria and pain points with questions like: “What is your biggest marketing challenge?” or “What would it cost you to not fix this problem?”. Seek to isolate an objection, e.g., “That’s a good reason not to invest in this today. [Add a meaningful pause.] I’m just curious: is money the only thing standing between you and the purchase of this solution?”. If there are no other objections, then ask, “So, if we can make this product affordable for you, you will buy it?”
- Close the sale. If you truly believe that your prospect will benefit from your product or service, go ahead with the close.
- Follow-up. Even after closing a sale, you need to constantly remind your buyers why they bought from you, and find new ways to keep educating them and adding value. The

KEY QUOTES

“The secret to building an excellent sales force (or team of any kind) is in repeating core training on basic sales skills again and again.”

“Your job is to set up systems, procedures, and training that create a machine where every salesperson gets deep with your prospects.”

more you focus on the prospect during the 6 steps above, the more information you'll have for your follow up.



10 steps to great follow up. Systemize your processes to strengthen client bonds and keep them happy.

- Send your first letter within 1-2 hours of your meeting. Start with something personal, include a compliment, push the hot buttons, recap the benefits you can offer and end with a personal close.
- Follow up with a call, focusing on providing value such as ideas or information for their challenge.
- Each month, share something of personal interest to the client.
- Ease into their personal lives with bonding events like parties or meals.
- Follow up from each event with a letter/card/fax/email, keeping it short and personal. Reinforce what else you'll do for the relationship.
- Plan something fun that can involve their family.
- Offer ways to help your client succeed, e.g. connect them to other potential clients or bring them to a useful seminar.
- Stay top of mind with more cards/letters/emails.
- Keep offering your help to become an asset and confidant.
- Aim to eventually invite them to your home or be invited to theirs.



Part 4: Operating your Ultimate Sales Machine (USM)



To build your USM, you need to apply, track and consistently improve the strategies above until it comes naturally to you.



Your Organizational USM. Identify the measures of effectiveness for your key goals (e.g. the number of calls or presentations made), track them and reward performance

KEY QUOTES

"If you are friends with your clients, it is very hard for another salesperson to take them away from you."

"Become involved in (your clients') lives and in the success of their businesses. Make it your personal mission to help them succeed."

"Implementation, not ideas, is the key to real success."

until these are part of your organization's DNA.



Your Personal USM. You can use the same approach to train yourself to naturally focus on opportunities around you.

- Your brain's reticular activating system (RAS) scans the environment based on the often-subconscious instructions that you give it. Focus your mind on success and keep demanding your brain to find solutions.
- Use workshops to define your goals (e.g. lifetime goals, annual goals), or find ways to create success (e.g. 3 things to do each month to improve your life, 3 things to do each month to make your team more effective).

The idea is to have the discipline and determination to stay focused on what matters, until it's second-nature for you to achieve your goals.



Other Details in the Book to Look out For



This book is packed with resources and detailed examples to help you understand and apply the strategies outlined in this summary. These include:

- Examples, scripts and tips for workshop training, recruitment, interviews, advertising/marketing campaigns, pitches, letters and follow-up;
- Stories and anecdotes from a wide range of businesses, based on Holmes' and his clients' experiences; and
- Exercises (including reflections, assessments etc.) to help you apply and customize the tips for your business.

For more details and resources, please visit www.chetholmes.com.

KEY QUOTES

"Attitude is the only thing we can control in life, yet it's also the most powerful."

"If you make this book your sales, marketing and management bible and study it again and again, you'll never need to know anything else to rule your market. That and pigheaded determination."